**Priorities and Leadership Competencies for the Principal Selection Process**

Dear Dr. Balasubramanian and other members of the principal slating process,

As the Collaboration Leadership Team (CLT) at Newcomer Academy, we are elected representatives of the staff population. We wish to articulate the critical priorities of faculty members regarding the selection of our next principal and to express significant concerns regarding the current search process.

## Procedural Concerns & District Vision

As an A5 school, the staff at Newcomer Academy are uniquely positioned to advocate for the wellbeing of a vulnerable population, of which we have been serving for more than 20 years. The faculty in this building are highly-qualified experts who have the trust of our immigrant and refugee communities. We have a specific understanding of the needs of this population, as many staff members share the same experiences as our student body, and this gives us unique insight on who we know is best to lead this community.

We must address systemic issues within the selection framework. The current process has been characterized by unclear communication, truncated timelines, and insufficient opportunities for meaningful participation. The initial plan outlined for staff input was removed and altered mid-process, which stunted the democratic electoral participation of staff members and reduced transparency. The short timeline for onboarding left little room for the CLT to receive staff feedback before deadlines. Furthermore, a lack of transparent vision from the district—exacerbated by external factors— has severely hindered our institutional momentum and growth.

Despite these impediments, the CLT received feedback from staff members and have identified one key Problem of Practice (PoP), which will be documented per the district guidelines. The major area of staff concern that the CLT wishes to address is school vision, specifically affecting low enrollment. Because of the unprecedented low ratios of students to staff, many staff members have been overstaffed, causing disruptions not just to scheduling, but climate and culture. The CLT is looking for a leader who can create an action plan that will retain and recruit both staff and students to Newcomer.

## Essential Leadership Competencies

Based on staff look-fors, the slating committee is strongly encouraged to prioritize a candidate who demonstrates the following qualities. These qualities align with a leader who will ensure the continuity of success for students and promote long-term retention in the staff population.

- **Instructional Leadership & Academic Rigor:** Proven ability to balance rigorous academic standards with targeted, evidence-based remediation for historically disadvantaged populations.
- **Cultural Responsiveness & Community Engagement:** Deep familiarity with the socio-economic and structural barriers impacting immigrant and refugee communities, paired with exceptional cross-cultural communication skills.
- **Operational Expertise & Post-Secondary Pathways:** Comprehensive mastery of administrative operations, non-traditional graduation pathways, and actionable college-and-career readiness initiatives.
- **Holistic Student Support:** A commitment to a "whole-child" educational philosophy that diagnoses and resolves the root causes of academic and behavioral challenges.
- **Resource Optimization & Professional Growth:** Expertise in strategically deploying technological tools, high-quality curriculum, and targeted professional development.
- **Culture, Climate & Strategic Positioning:** Capability to safeguard established institutional strengths while intentionally steering school climate enhancement. Plans for the school's vision and rebuild staff and student morale and provide a long-term vision.

**Proposal for Performance Task**

Per the original selection timeline, we understand that a performance task will be completed by the candidates. In order to promote staff buy-in and boost morale we propose the following: the performance task shall be: 1) a written justification that the candidate possesses the aforementioned qualities, and, 2) a proposal for addressing the school's main Problem of Practice (PoP) of school vision (with a focus on low enrollment) as outlined by the school's CLT.

Respectfully,
The Collaboration Leadership Team